

Everybody Who Has To Prove The Money Is There

Payment providers, law firms, mortgage brokerages, property managers, insolvency trustees, insurance brokers, travel agents and the rest all hold money that belongs to somebody else. Every one of them owes a written duty to keep it separate, reconcile it, evidence it and keep the record for years. This paper sets out each population: who regulates it, how often the duty falls, how firmly the count is established, and what one engine has to add to serve it.

18,254

FIRMS THAT OWE
THE DUTY

31

SEGMENTS ACROSS
ELEVEN REGULATORS

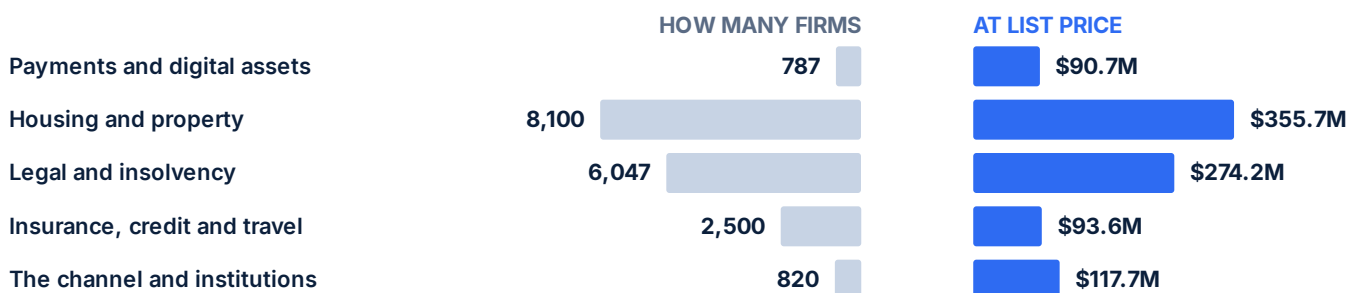
10,929

COUNTED FROM A
PUBLISHED REGISTER

1

ENGINE UNDERNEATH
ALL OF THEM

1 The five families, and what each is worth at list price



Every segment appears exactly once and in one family only. Bars share a scale on each side, so the two columns can be read against each other. Housing and property is the largest family on both counts. The useful comparison is the one between the two columns: payments holds 4 per cent of the firms and 10 per cent of the value, because its firms sit in the higher price bands, while housing holds 44 per cent of the firms and 38 per cent of the value. Payments is the smallest family in this paper and the densest.

Why the smallest family is the one to start in

Payments is the only family whose population is published by its regulator as a list, with a flag on each entry showing which firms hold other people's money. Every other family is assembled from a provincial register, a federal business count or an estimate. A named list of 745 is a different sales proposition from an estimate of three thousand, a difference 02.4 puts at roughly twenty times in the share a vendor ends up holding.

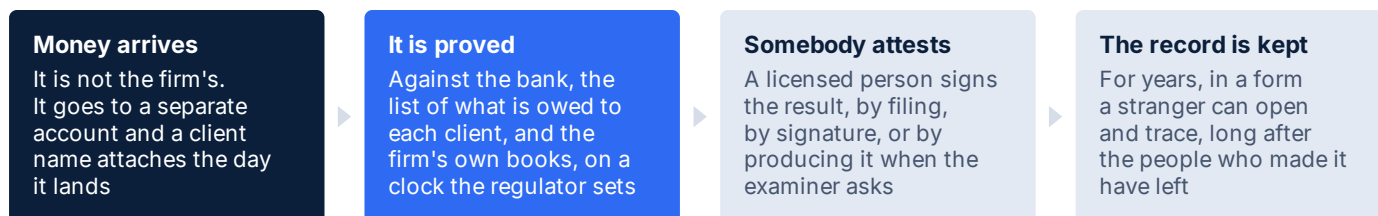
2 How to read this, in one page

Every segment carries a letter. The letter answers two questions and it is the first thing to read, before any number. Does the duty apply to these firms, and do we know how many there are. A count taken off a regulator's own list is not the same as a count worked out from one province, and this paper never treats them as though they were.

Grade	What it means	Firms	At list price
A, counted and the rule is in writing	Both questions answered. The firms come off a regulator's own list with a date on it, and the duty is written in a rule we have read ourselves. This is the tier the plan sells into first and the only one a forecast should rest on	10,929	\$505,053,450
B, the rule is in writing, the count is ours	The duty is as solid as in A. What is missing is a published head count, so the number of firms is worked out from one province, a federal business count or an industry body. A week of counting per regulator moves a segment from B to A	7,325	\$426,911,000

Legend. Firms and value are the totals for every segment carrying that grade. Thirteen of the thirty one segments are graded A and they hold 10,929 of the 18,254 firms, so 60 per cent of the population is counted rather than estimated.

3 The same four steps, in all thirty one segments



The money is different in each segment, the regulator is different and the deadline is different. The work underneath is the same work. That is why one platform reaches thirty one segments rather than one, and it is why each segment after the first costs a fraction of the first to serve.

What the grade is not

A grade is about evidence, not about attractiveness. A B graded segment is not a worse market than an A graded one; it is a market whose head count nobody has sat down and counted yet. Several of the largest and most obligated populations in this paper are B, and they are B because their regulator publishes a licensee list without publishing a total. That is a week of work, and it is listed at the back as work still to do rather than claimed as done.

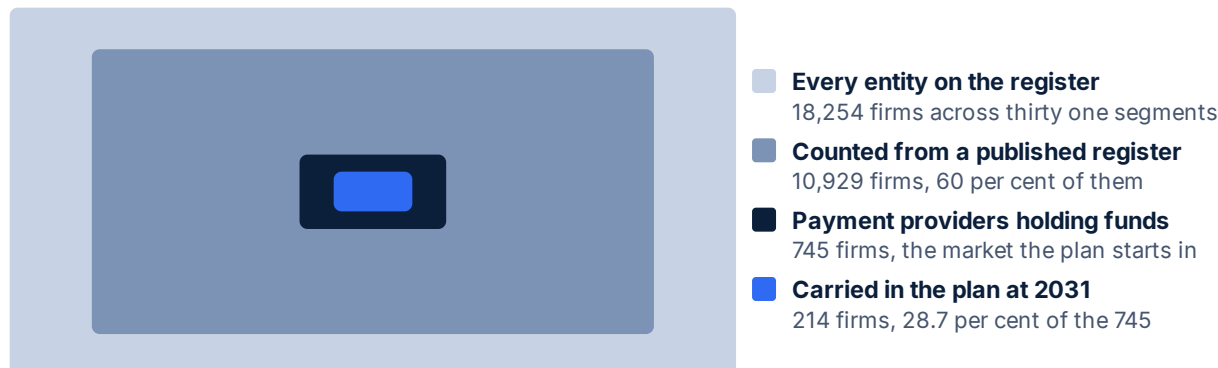
4 Every segment, its regulator and its clock

Segment	Who regulates it	How often the duty falls	Firms	Grade
Payment providers holding funds, all sizes	Bank of Canada	A ledger of each end user's position at the close of every day, plus an annual report on 31 March. Includes the 25 largest processors	745	A and B
Canadian dollar stablecoin issuers	Bank of Canada, framework enacted	Monthly reporting including certified accountant statements, once the regulations publish	20	B
Crypto asset trading platforms	Canadian Securities Administrators	Client asset segregation on each platform's own undertaking terms	22	A
Institutions buying directly	Prudential regulators	Banks and credit unions buying for their own regulated obligations rather than for a trust duty	20	B
Mortgage administrators and brokerages	Provincial regulators, Ontario first	Money the statute treats as held in trust, a two day deposit rule and six year retention	3,208	A and B
Real estate brokerages	Provincial real estate councils	Monthly trust reconciliation in most provinces, reviewed and signed by the broker of record	1,392	A
Property management brokerages	Provincial real estate councils	Monthly, on rent and damage deposits, ledgered by unit	3,500	B
Law firms	Provincial law societies	A monthly reconciliation of three records against each other, the bank, the list of what is owed to each client and the firm's own books, on a clock each society sets	5,687	A
Licensed insolvency trustees	Office of the Superintendent of Bankruptcy	Per estate reconciliation, within forty five days of the statement date	360	B
Insurance brokerages	Provincial insurance councils	Twice a year plus a year end filing	1,200	B
Collection agencies	Provincial consumer ministries	On request, within thirty days	400	B
Travel registrants	Provincial travel regulators	On surplus transfer, which is a continuous calculation rather than a date	900	B
The channel: reviewers, accountants, networks	Professional bodies	At each client engagement. These firms carry no trust duty of their own and sit in front of dozens of firms that do	800	B

Legend. Grade A means counted from a regulator's own list with the duty read at its source. Grade B means the duty is equally solid and the count is ours. Where a row spans both, part of it is counted and part scaled. The firms column sums to 18,254, the whole register, with every firm appearing once.

Eleven regulators, and not one of them accepts another's format. That is the work, and it is also the barrier: a foreign entrant has to do all of it rather than any of it, and there is no reason for a vendor built on another country's rules to start.

5 The register, drawn from the outside in



Each box is drawn so its area is proportional to the count inside it, largest outermost. The outer box is every firm in this paper. The plan lives in the innermost one. The distance between the two is the reason this document exists and also the reason it is not a forecast: the outer boxes are populations with a written duty attached, not customers.

6 Where each family sits, counted against what a firm is worth



Horizontal position is the share of a family's firms taken off a regulator's own list rather than estimated. Vertical position is what one firm in that family is worth at list price, against the dearest family. Blue is payments. It is the only family that is both counted and dear, which is the corner a company with one build and no customers should start in. The channel sits at the opposite corner and is entered last for exactly that reason.

7 One engine, every clock

The engine is one build. Matching a bank feed against a client ledger, holding a record that cannot be altered afterwards, raising an exception and keeping the result for years is identical whether the account holds customer money held by a payment provider, a legal retainer, a purchase deposit, a rent deposit, an estate distribution or a stablecoin reserve. What differs is the shape of the report each regulator wants and the clock it runs on.

Segment	The clock	What has to be built on top
Payment providers	Continuous, with an annual report	Safeguarding framework evidence, the daily safeguarded amount, an incident log and the annual report in the regulator's own form
Stablecoin issuers	Monthly certified reserve	Continuous reserve position, composition disclosure and custodian reconciliation
Crypto asset trading platforms	On each platform's own undertaking	Client asset segregation against a custodian feed, reported in the shape of that firm's terms
Law firms, Ontario	By the twenty fifth of the following month	Three way report in the law society format, with ten year retention
Law firms, British Columbia	Within thirty days of month end	The same report, a different format, seven year retention and version history on electronic records
Law firms, Alberta	Before the end of the next month	The same report again, a responsible lawyer signature and a seven day shortfall notice
Mortgage brokerages and administrators	Two day deposit, six year retention	Separation of money the statute treats as held in trust whether or not it sits in a trust account, a deposit timing test and a file completeness pack
Real estate brokerages	Monthly in most provinces	Deposit trust by deal, the provincial council format, and an Alberta compliance programme
Property management brokerages	Monthly to a provincial council	Rent and damage deposit ledger by unit, in the council's report format
Licensed insolvency trustees	Forty five days from the statement date	Per estate reconciliation at volume, with a consolidated attestation
Insurance brokerages	Twice a year plus year end	A position report carrying three positions on one page
Collection agencies	On request, within thirty days	Deposit and payout timing tests, and a countdown to the date unclaimed money must be handed to the province
Travel registrants	On surplus transfer	A continuous surplus calculation rather than a periodic report

Legend. Thirteen report packs, each on its own clock. That is engineering per segment rather than a setting, and it is the reason a foreign entrant does not arrive quickly.

8 How often the duty falls, and how many firms stand behind each clock

At the close of every day		745	payment providers holding funds
Monthly		10,599	law firms, brokerages, stablecoin issuers
A two day deposit test, then retention		3,208	mortgage administrators
Twice a year plus a year end filing		1,200	insurance brokerages
Continuous, on surplus transfer		900	travel registrants
At each client engagement		800	reviewers, accountants, networks
On request, within thirty days		400	collection agencies
Within forty five days of a statement		360	insolvency trustees
On the firm's own undertaking		42	crypto platforms and direct buyers

Every firm in the register appears once and the nine clocks sum to 18,254. Blue is the daily clock, which is the one segment the plan sells into today and the only clock in the set that cannot be discharged by hand. Monthly is the largest by a distance, and it is the clock a bookkeeper currently meets with a spreadsheet. Nothing here is a frequency the product chooses; each one is written into the rule that binds that segment.

9 What the engine does once, and what each clock adds on top

- 1 The bank feed**
 The account is read directly. Identical whether it holds end user float, a legal retainer, a purchase deposit, a rent deposit or a stablecoin reserve
- 2 The ledger match**
 What the bank says, against what is owed to each client, against the firm's own books. One routine, thirty one segments
- 3 The record that cannot be altered afterwards**
 Entries are added and never changed, so a position stated for a day years ago can still be produced on demand
- 4 The exception queue and the retention rule**
 A break is raised, worked and closed. The retention period differs by province and is a setting rather than a build
- 5 The report pack**
 One per regulator, in that regulator's own format, on that regulator's clock. There are thirteen of them and this is the work

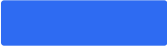
Navy is built once and shared by every segment. Blue is built once and configured per segment. Pale is built again for each regulator. Four of the five layers are reused, which is why the second segment costs a fraction of the first. The fifth is content and formatting rather than architecture, which is also why it is cheap for a foreign vendor to copy once they decide to start.

10 Where the firms are, and where the value is

Family	Firms	Share of firms	At list price	Share of value	What sits in it
Payments and digital assets	787	4.3%	\$90,748,000	9.7%	Payment providers at every size, stablecoin issuers, crypto platforms and the largest processors
Housing and property	8,100	44.4%	\$355,747,300	38.2%	Mortgage administrators and brokerages, real estate brokerages and property managers
Legal and insolvency	6,047	33.1%	\$274,163,150	29.4%	Law firms at three sizes and licensed insolvency trustees
Insurance, credit and travel	2,500	13.7%	\$93,566,000	10.0%	Insurance brokerages at three sizes, collection agencies and travel registrants
The channel and institutions	820	4.5%	\$117,740,000	12.6%	Reviewers, accounting and assurance firms, networks, and institutions that resell or buy directly
All thirty one segments	18,254	100%	\$931,964,450	100%	Less \$91,492,500 of overlap gives \$840,471,950

Legend. At list price: firms multiplied by the one list price for their size band. Shares are struck on the gross figures before the overlap deduction, which is 2,400 small firms at \$29,450 and 250 mid market firms at \$83,250, being the firms that would reach the product through a partner rather than directly. All figures are Canadian dollars.

11 The five price bands the segments fall into

Command and institution, \$687,000		\$44.7M • 65 firms
Enterprise and complex, \$219,500		\$121.2M • 552 firms
Partner and white label, \$130,000		\$104.0M • 800 firms
Mid market regulated, \$83,250		\$257.3M • 3,091 firms
Small regulated firm, \$29,450		\$404.8M • 13,746 firms

Bands are in price order, highest first, and bar length is what each is worth at list price. The two do not run together: the cheapest band is the most valuable, because it holds three quarters of the firms. There is one list price per band, and a segment sits in the band that matches the size and complexity of its firms rather than the industry they are in. A law firm of five people and a payment provider of five people pay the same, because they buy the same thing.

12 What it costs them today, and what the comparison is

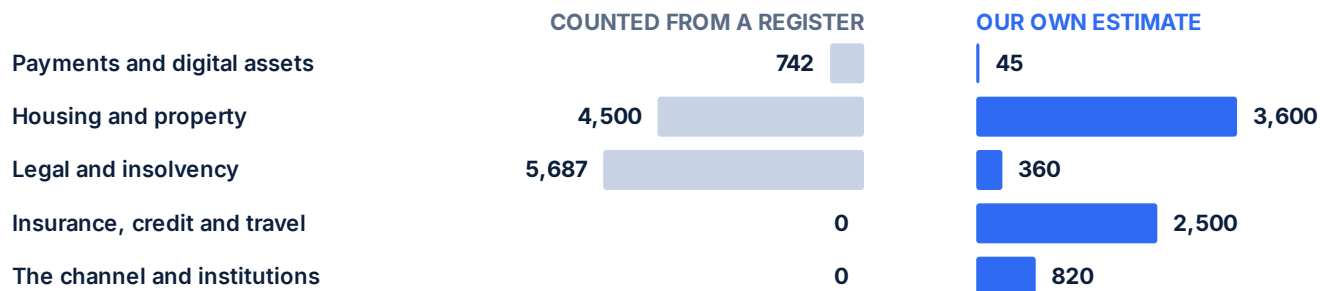
Segment	What it costs today	What the buyer compares it against
Payment providers, small	A daily reconciliation cannot be done by hand. A firm doing it properly assigns most of one person to the float; a firm not doing it properly finds out at the first examination	Most of a compliance salary at this size, against the subscription. The comparison is against hiring, not against other software
Payment providers, mid market	A named compliance officer spends a large share of the year assembling evidence across safeguarding, incidents and the annual report rather than judging it	A share of a compliance officer's fully loaded cost, and whatever the firm is quoted for reserve reporting on its own
Law firms	A monthly three way reconciliation prepared from two systems, on a clock, with the responsible lawyer's signature on the result	Bookkeeper hours every month, plus the cost of a law society spot audit finding
Mortgage and real estate brokerages	Deposit timing tested by hand against a two day rule, and files assembled per deal for retention periods measured in years	Administrative hours, and the cost of a council finding that reaches the licence
Property management brokerages	Rent and damage deposits ledgered by unit across hundreds of units, reconciled monthly to a council format	Whichever staff member currently owns the spreadsheet
Licensed insolvency trustees	Per estate reconciliation at volume, inside forty five days of the statement date	The trustee's own time, which is the most expensive hour in the firm
Every segment	The same underlying thing: a position that has to be true on a stated day, assembled afterwards from records that were not built to be assembled	The examination, the finding, and in the worst case the registration itself

Legend. What the buyer compares against decides the price they will pay, and it is not usually another vendor. In most of these segments there is no other vendor.

The incumbent, named

In Ontario real estate the incumbent is a spreadsheet published by the regulator itself: the council tells brokerages the broker of record must review trust reconciliations monthly, and supplies an Excel template for firms without accounting software. That is the competitor in that segment, and it is worth stating plainly because it sets both the bar and the price.

13 How firmly each family is counted



Legal is almost entirely counted, because federal business counts publish law firm numbers by staff size. Housing is counted in Ontario and scaled elsewhere. The channel is entirely estimated, because no roster of independent reviewers or assurance firms is published anywhere. Each segment carries its own basis in the model and is marked so a reader can discount it.



The whole register on one bar. Sixty per cent counted is an ordinary result for a market spanning eleven regulators, and it is a better result than most market work discloses at all. The payments family, which is the one the plan actually sells into, sits almost entirely inside the counted sixty.

14 What would move a segment from estimated to counted

A week per regulator, and no more than that

Most of the estimated segments have a provincial registrar who publishes a licensee list. The work is sitting down with that list on a stated date and counting it, which is a week of work per regulator rather than a research programme.

The two that cannot be counted yet

Independent reviewers and accounting firms doing this work have no published roster in any province. They are estimated at 120 and 400, and both figures should be read as the weakest in the register. They are also the distribution channel, which is why the estimate matters more than its size suggests.

One that will be counted for us

Stablecoin issuers are estimated at 20 today because no register exists. The enacted framework creates a public register at the Bank of Canada, so the moment the regulations publish this segment becomes a counted one without anybody doing the counting.

15 What is confirmed, and what is still open

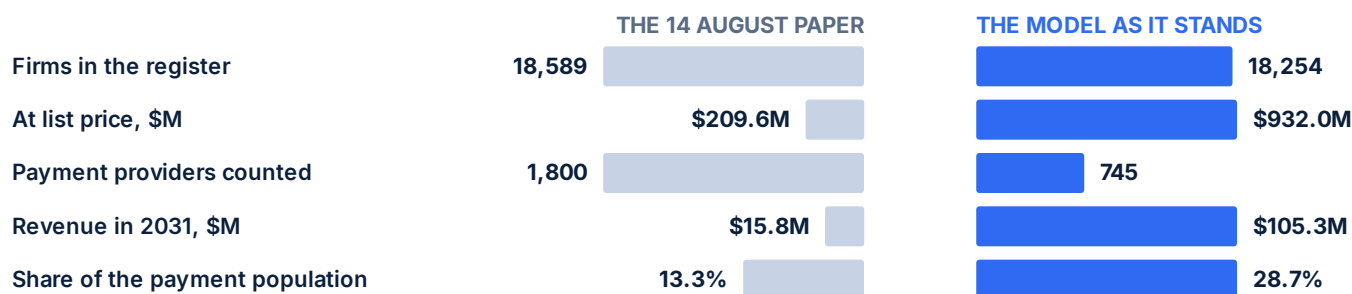
Confirmed against a published rule

The payment provider duty and its daily ledger, read at the regulation. The annual report and its 31 March date. The Ontario mortgage administrator filing requirements. The Ontario law society monthly reconciliation and its twenty five day clock. The Ontario real estate council monthly requirement and the broker of record's obligation to review it. The mortgage industry's money laundering obligations from 11 October 2024.

Still open, and marked as such

Provincial rules outside Ontario have been read in summary rather than line by line, so the clocks stated for other provinces are indicative. Retention periods vary by province and are not yet all read at source. No count exists for the channel. And no customer in any segment outside payments has yet said the duty hurts enough to buy.

16 What this document supersedes



Bars are scaled within each row, because the five rows are in firms, dollars and per cent and share no scale. Read each row against itself and read the figures rather than the bar lengths across rows.

What the 14 August paper said

Nineteen streams across 18,589 firms worth \$209,646,424 a year

A price ladder of \$18,000 small, \$54,000 mid market and \$6,000 for most provincial trust segments

A population of 1,800 registered and pending payment providers

Comparator prices converted at an exchange rate of 1.4068

2031 revenue of \$15,826,838 and a reach of 13.3 per cent of small payment firms

What the model carries now

Thirty one segments across 18,254 firms worth \$931,964,450 at list price, or \$840,471,950 after removing firms counted twice

One card: \$29,450 small, \$83,250 mid market, \$219,500 enterprise, \$687,000 command and \$130,000 partner, with a segment placed in the band that matches its size

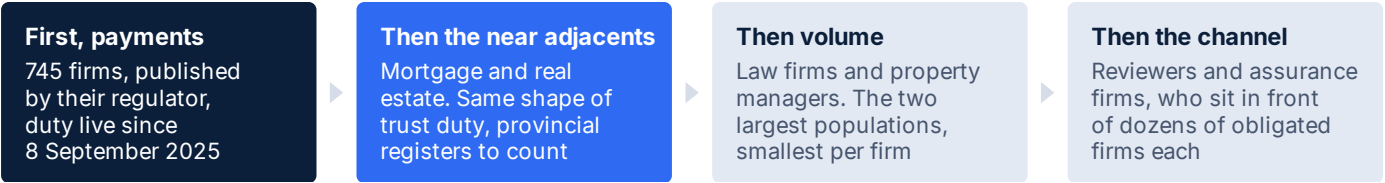
745 firms carrying the holding of funds flag, which is the population the duty actually binds, with 459 more counted on the same register as applied and undecided, held outside the total

The Bank of Canada rate of 14 August 2026, 1.3875 for the United States dollar. The converted comparator figures in the earlier paper are withdrawn

\$105,276,946 of revenue in 2031 and 28.7 per cent of the 745 firms that hold funds

Legend. Withdrawn means the figure is not to be used, quoted or restated anywhere. The firm count moved because the register was rebuilt to drop segments owing no trust duty and to stop counting firms twice where they reach the product through a partner.

17 The order the segments are taken in, and why



The order is not by size. Payments is the smallest family of the five. It is first because it is the only one whose population is published as a list by the regulator that supervises it, because the duty is already in force, and because the enforcement record is public. Everything after it reuses the engine and adds a report format and a clock.

18 What each new segment actually costs to add

What is reused	What is new per segment
The bank feed and the ledger match	Nothing. Identical whether the account holds end user float or a legal retainer
The record that cannot be altered afterwards	Nothing. The same structure, which allows entries to be added and never altered, carries any duty
The exception queue and the retention rules	The retention period, which is a setting rather than a build
The rule engine	The rules themselves, which are written content with dates attached rather than code
The report generator	One report pack per regulator, in that regulator's own format. This is the real work and there are thirteen of them

Legend. Four of the five rows reuse. The fifth is the work, and it is content and formatting rather than architecture, which is why the marginal cost of the second segment is a fraction of the first and why it is also cheap for a competitor to copy once they decide to start.

The symmetry worth stating out loud

The property that makes the second segment cheap for us makes a Canadian mapping cheap for a foreign entrant. Four vendors already sell this exact shape of software in the United Kingdom, and adding a Canadian report pack is content work measured in weeks rather than engineering measured in years. The defence is not the code. It is the dated content and the months of customer records already accumulated when they arrive, and every month that passes widens that by one month nobody can backfill.

19 What this document does not claim

It is not a forecast

Nothing here is in the plan except payments. The other families are populations with duties attached, priced at the card to show what they would be worth. No revenue from them appears in the model, and no date is attached to entering any of them.

It is not evidence of demand

A duty is not a budget and an obligation is not a purchase. Outside payments, no firm in any of these segments has been asked what the duty costs them or what they would pay to be rid of it. Until they have, every one of these families is a hypothesis with a regulation behind it.

The provincial rules are read unevenly

Ontario is read at source across mortgage, real estate and legal. Other provinces are read in summary. The clocks stated for firms outside Ontario are indicative and would need to be read line by line before any of them is sold against.

The channel is the weakest count and the most important one

Independent reviewers and assurance firms have no published roster, so 120 and 400 are estimates. They are also the distribution route every comparable vendor in 02.4 depended on. A segment that matters most and is counted least is worth naming rather than burying.

The one line to carry out of this document

Thirty one segments, eleven regulators, thirteen report packs, one engine. The money is different every time, the deadline is different every time, and the work underneath is the same work. That is the whole argument for why this is a platform rather than a product, and it is also why the first segment has to be won before any of the rest is worth discussing.

What to do with this paper

Read it beside 02.1, which sizes the market, and 02.4, which tests the plan against what comparable vendors achieved. This one is the map of who owes what to whom, and it is the answer to why a company selling to 745 firms is describing a platform.

What would change it

A week per regulator counting licensee lists moves most of the estimated segments to counted. One customer conversation in any family outside payments moves that family from a population with a duty to a market with demand.

Sources. Every count, price and derived figure comes from the master pro forma of 17 August 2026, on the Population Register tab, where each segment carries its own basis and source. The payment provider duty is in [SOR/2023-229](#) and the population is counted from the [Bank of Canada register](#). The Ontario mortgage filing requirements are at the [Financial Services Regulatory Authority](#), the law society reconciliation at [the Law Society of Ontario](#), and the real estate requirement and its template at [the Real Estate Council of Ontario](#). Money laundering obligations for the mortgage sector are at the [Financial Transactions and Reports Analysis Centre of Canada](#).